

MODULE 04

Pricing: How Much to Charge and How to Present It

Pricing is the single biggest leverage point in your cohosting practice. Charge too little and you burn out. Charge too much and you never get the client. This module gives you the actual numbers, where they come from, and the proposal structure that wins.

The market-rate bands (US, 2026)

These are the bands we have seen across short-term-rental markets in the US in the twelve months leading up to this kit. Use them as a sanity check before you sign — if your number is outside these bands, you are either underselling yourself or trying to overreach.

Single-family home, lower-density market, \$100-180 ADR: 20-25% of booking subtotal is standard. Below 20% is a red flag for the owner (you probably don't have the experience). Above 25% is premium (you should have a track record to back this up).

Cabin / lakehouse, mid-density market, \$180-300 ADR: 22-28%. Cabins require more logistics (winter prep, snow, road access). The premium is justified if you can demonstrate it.

Luxury / high-density urban, \$300+ ADR: 25-30%. These owners have high expectations, often have prior cohost experience, and will negotiate hard. Your edge is responsiveness and high-touch service, not pricing.

Furnished Finder / mid-term rentals (30+ nights average stay): 10-15% of booking subtotal. Long stays mean fewer turns, fewer cleanings, fewer messages. Your percentage should reflect the per-booking work, not the per-night revenue.

How to set your number

Don't anchor on what feels fair. Anchor on what your time is worth across a working month. Here's the calculation:

Step 1. Estimate the average time you will spend per property per month. Most cohosts working a single property: 15-25 hours. With multiple properties and good SOPs: 8-15 hours each.

Step 2. Decide what hourly rate you need to make this worth doing. Established cohosts target \$50-100/hour effective rate. If you are new, you can target \$30-50 to start, but you will outgrow this within 12 months if you are doing the work well.

Step 3. Multiply time × hourly. If you spend 18 hours/month and want \$50/hour, you need \$900/month per property. Convert that to a percentage based on expected monthly revenue:

Expected monthly revenue ÷ target monthly take = the percentage you need. If the property does \$4,000/month in bookings, \$900 is 22.5%. Round to 23%.

Step 4. Compare to your market band above. If your number is in the band, you are priced correctly. If it's below the band, you're underselling; if above, you're asking for a premium you can't back up yet.

The proposal structure that wins

Owners don't buy the lowest price. They buy the clearest plan. Your proposal should have exactly these sections, in this order:

- 1. Property snapshot.** Name, address, current platform, current review score, current monthly revenue (from the listing audit). Three sentences max. Prove you actually looked at it.
- 2. Three things I will do in month one.** Specific, verifiable, fast. Examples: re-do the listing photos, fix the calendar sync between Airbnb and VRBO, restage the second bedroom for the photos. Don't promise revenue lift yet — promise setup work that lifts revenue later.
- 3. Pricing.** One number, in the structure you have chosen. Include what is in the fee and what is pass-through. No tables of three pricing options — owners find them confusing and pick the wrong one.
- 4. Timeline.** When you start, when the first statement is sent, when the quarterly review happens. Owners want to know when the next deliverable is.
- 5. What I need from you.** Property access, master calendar login, STR license, insurance certificate, cleaning crew handoff if applicable. Setting these expectations up front prevents the most common reason cohost relationships fail.

When to ask for more

Three signals it's time to renegotiate upward:

- You have hit the original targets on time for two consecutive quarters
- The owner has referred another owner to you (referrals are the strongest pricing signal there is)
- You are at capacity — you cannot take a new property without dropping the service level on existing ones

Renegotiation is a 15-minute conversation, not a contract rewrite. Frame it as: "Here's what I've delivered against our plan. Here's what the next quarter looks like. Here's the revised number I'm asking for."

Module 04 — Done. Module 05 covers the listing audit — the first deliverable that earns you the right to a second conversation.